

Credit - Drishti Ias

IAEA Refers Iran to UNSC Over Nuclear Non-Compliance

Source: AIR

The **International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA)** has formally referred **Iran to the United Nations Security Council (UNSC)** for the first time in 20 years due to Tehran's persistent failure to comply with its **nuclear non-proliferation obligations** and its severe lack of cooperation with international nuclear inspectors.

- **The Vote:** The resolution, sponsored by the US, UK, France, and Germany, was adopted with 23 votes in favour, 3 against (Russia, China, and Niger), 8 abstentions, and one Board member not voting.
 - Although a UNSC referral opens the door for sweeping global **sanctions and asset freezes**, punitive measures are unlikely. Iran's allies, **Russia and China, hold veto power** as permanent members of the UNSC and are expected to block any punitive resolutions.
- **Core Concerns:** The referral highlights Iran's failure to explain anthropogenic (man-made) **uranium** traces found at several undeclared sites.
 - The IAEA estimates Iran holds around **440.9 kilograms of uranium enriched to 60% purity** - a short technical step away from the 90% weapons-grade threshold.
- **Iran's Nuclear Program and IAEA Concerns:**
 - **The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA):** Signed in 2015 between **Iran and the P5+1 (China, France, Russia, UK, US, plus Germany)**, the **JCPOA** strictly limited Iran's nuclear program in exchange for the lifting of economic sanctions.
 - In 2018, the US unilaterally withdrew from the JCPOA and reinstated harsh "maximum pressure" sanctions. In response, **Iran gradually breached the deal's limits on uranium enrichment.**
 - **NPT Safeguards Agreement:** Independent of the JCPOA, Iran is a party to the **Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT)** and is obligated to comply with its **Comprehensive Safeguards Agreement (CSA)** with the IAEA.
 - The safeguards framework requires Iran to declare its nuclear material and facilities and enables the **IAEA to verify that nuclear material is not diverted for weapons purposes**.
 - Following the **June 2025 US-Israeli strikes**, Iran restricted IAEA access to several nuclear sites, significantly impairing the Agency's ability to verify Iran's nuclear activities and stockpiles.
 - These restrictions have prevented the IAEA from fully carrying out its verification responsibilities under Iran's safeguards obligations.

International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA)

- The **IAEA** is an **intergovernmental organisation established in 1957** as the world's **"Atoms for Peace" organisation** to promote the peaceful use of nuclear energy and prevent its military use.

- Headquartered in **Vienna** , it reports to the **UNGA and UNSC** , and has **181 members (as of December 2025)** , with **India as a founding member** .
- The IAEA was awarded the **Nobel Peace Prize in 2005** for its contribution to a safer and more peaceful world

Read more: IAEA-Iran Dispute Over Alleged Natanz Strike

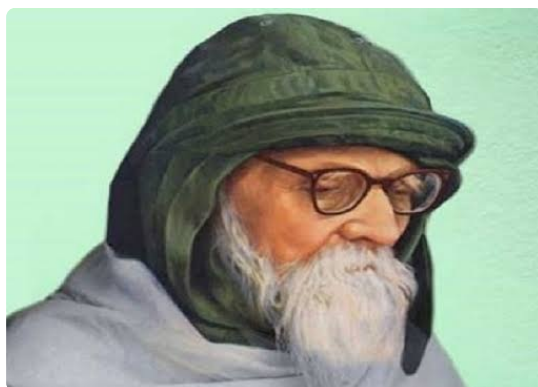
Birth Anniversary of Acharya Vinoba Bhave

Source: PIB

Recently, the Prime Minister paid tribute to **Acharya Vinoba Bhave on his birth anniversary** , recalling his message of **‘Jai Jagat’** , which placed humanity above social, political and geographical boundaries.

- **About:** Vinayak Narahari Bhave, popularly known as **Acharya Vinoba Bhave** , was born on **11th September 1895 at Gagode, Bombay Presidency (Maharashtra)** . From an early age, he developed a deep interest in spirituality, Sanskrit, the Bhagavad Gita and the Upanishads.
- **Association with Gandhi:** Vinoba met **Mahatma Gandhi on 7th June 1916** and joined his Ashram, adopting the ideals of **non-violence, equality, austerity and village development** .
 - On **8th April 1921** , Gandhi sent him to **Wardha** to take charge of an Ashram, where he published the Marathi monthly **Maharashtra Dharma** , containing essays on the **Upanishads** . The name **“Vinoba”** was given to him by **Mama Phadke** , an Ashram member.
- **Role in Freedom Struggle:** He participated in the **Non-Cooperation Movement** , promoted **Swadeshi and Khadi**. He played a prominent role in the Nagpur Flag Satyagraha of 1923 and was imprisoned for his participation.
 - During his imprisonment in Dhulia Jail in 1932, he delivered discourses on the Bhagavad Gita, which were later published as Gita Pravachane.
 - Gandhi selected him as the **first Individual Satyagrahi in 1940** , and he spent several years in prison for leading **non-violent resistance against British rule** .
- **Sarvodaya Movement:** Inspired by Gandhi, Vinoba promoted Sarvodaya, or the welfare and uplift of all, with emphasis on social equality, decentralisation, non-violence and self-reliant village communities.
- **Bhoodan Movement:** In **1951** , Vinoba began a peace trek through violence-affected **Telangana** .
 - At **Pochampalli** , a request for land for landless people led him to appeal to landlords for voluntary land donations, with a landlord donating the required land, marking the beginning of the **Bhoodan (Land Gift) Movement** .
 - The movement continued for **13 years** , during which he travelled about **58,741 km** , collected around **4.4 million acres of land** , and distributed approximately **1.3 million acres** among landless farmers.

- **Spiritual and Social Work:** Vinoba established several **Ashrams** promoting simple and self-sufficient living and founded **Brahma Vidya Mandir in 1959** , a community for women based on Gandhian principles of **self-sufficiency and simple living** . He also campaigned strongly against **cow slaughter** .
- **Literary Contributions:** His important works include **Swarajya Sastra**, **Geeta Pravachane** and **Teesri Shakti (The Third Power)** .
- **Awards and Recognition:** He became the first recipient of the **Ramon Magsaysay Award for Community Leadership in 1958** . He was awarded the **Bharat Ratna** posthumously in **1983** .
- **Death:** Acharya Vinoba Bhave died on **15 November 1982 at Paunar in Wardha district, Maharashtra** .



[Read More: Acharya Vinoba Bhave](#)

Swami Vivekananda's Historic Chicago Address

Source: PIB

Recently, the Prime Minister remembered **Swami Vivekananda's 1893 Chicago** Address highlighting its enduring contribution to presenting India's civilisational ethos, spiritual traditions and message of universal harmony to the world.

- **Historic Address:** Swami Vivekananda addressed the **World's Parliament of Religions in Chicago on 11 September 1893** , beginning with “ **Sisters and Brothers of America.**”
- **Universal Tolerance & Religious Pluralism:** He stressed that Hinduism teaches acceptance of **all religions as true** , with different spiritual paths ultimately leading to the same divine goal.
- **Critique of Fanaticism:** He strongly **condemned sectarianism, bigotry and religious fanaticism**, calling for religious harmony, coexistence and universal brotherhood.

Swami Vivekananda

- **About:** Swami Vivekananda, born as **Narendra Nath Datta on 12th January 1863** , in Kolkata was a monk and chief disciple of **Ramakrishna Paramhansa** . In 1893, at the request of **Maharaja Ajit Singh of Khetri** , he adopted the name ‘Vivekananda’, replacing ‘Sachidananda’.
- **Enlightenment:** In December **1892** , Vivekananda meditated on a **rock off Kanyakumari**, reflecting deeply on India’s past, present and future and on his mission for national and social regeneration. The site is today associated with the **Vivekananda Rock Memorial** .
- **Philosophical Contribution:** He popularised Indian philosophies of **Vedanta** and **Yoga** , and developed **Neo-Vedanta** , combining spirituality with material progress.
- **Spiritual Contribution:** Drawing from the **Upanishads** , **Gita** , **Buddha** and Jesus, he emphasised **self-realisation, compassion and selfless service** , including the idea that serving **Jiva is worship of Shiva** .
- **Pathways to Moksha:** He identified four paths to liberation— **Raja Yoga, Karma Yoga, Jnana Yoga and Bhakti Yoga** .
- **Education and Revivalism:** He advocated **man-making and character-building education** as a means of social regeneration and national reconstruction.
- **Nationalism:** His nationalism was rooted in **humanism and universalism** , with emphasis on **freedom, equality, upliftment of the masses and selfless service through Karma Yoga** .
- **Ramakrishna Mission:** He founded the **Ramakrishna Mission** in **1897** to promote **service, education and spiritual upliftment** , and established **Belur Math in 1899** .
- **Birth and Death Anniversaries:** Swami Vivekananda died on **4th July 1902 at Belur Math** , and his death anniversary is observed as **Nirvana Day** , while his **birth anniversary on 12th January** is celebrated in India as **National Youth Day** .



Read More: 162nd Birth Anniversary of Swami Vivekananda

Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)

Source: PIB

Why in News?

Recently, the **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)** completed **six years** , marking an important milestone in **India's fisheries sector**.

What are the Key Facts About PMMSY?

- **About:** Launched in **2020** , the **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)** builds on the **Blue Revolution scheme** to address critical gaps across the fisheries value chain and promote **inclusive, sustainable and modern fisheries development** .
- **Scheme Structure:** PMMSY is an umbrella scheme comprising a Central Sector Scheme and a Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS).
 - Its major components include production and productivity enhancement, infrastructure and post-harvest management, and fisheries management and regulation.



- **Financial Outlay:** PMMSY has a total outlay of **₹20,750 crore** , with a **record ₹2,500 crore allocated in BE 2026-27** to strengthen fisheries infrastructure and livelihoods.
- **Infrastructure Investment:** Between **2020-21 and 2025-26** , fisheries and aquaculture projects worth **₹21,394.88 crore** were approved, including a **Central share of ₹9,510.89 crore** , based on proposals from States, UTs and implementing agencies.



Key Components and Sub-Scheme under PMMSY

- **PM-MKSSY:** The **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana (PM-MKSSY)** is a **Central Sector sub-scheme under PMMSY**, operational across all States/UTs during **2023-24 to 2026-27**, with an estimated outlay of **₹6,000 crore**. It focuses on **formalisation, insurance, institutional finance, quality assurance and traceability**.
- **Production & Productivity:** The CSS component promotes technology-driven improvements across **inland and marine fisheries, mariculture, seaweed cultivation, Himalayan and North-Eastern fisheries, and ornamental fisheries**.
- **Infrastructure & Post-Harvest:** The CSS component strengthens **fishing harbours, fish landing centres, cold chains, post-harvest facilities, deep-sea fishing, coastal fishing villages, markets and marketing infrastructure**.
- **Fisheries Management & Safety:** The CSS component promotes **monitoring, control and surveillance**, fisher and vessel **insurance**, fisheries extension services, and **safety and security of fishers at sea**, while supporting their livelihood and nutritional needs.

How has PMMSY Strengthened Production, Infrastructure and Livelihoods?

- **Growth in Fish Production:** PMMSY has contributed to a significant rise in fish production, increasing it from **141.64 lakh tonnes in 2019-20 to a record 197.75 lakh tonnes in 2024-25**, reflecting improved productivity and sectoral growth.
- **Employment Generation:** The scheme has created **direct and indirect employment opportunities for around 58 lakh persons** engaged in fisheries and aquaculture-related activities.
- **Growth in Fisheries Exports:** Fisheries exports increased from **₹46,663 crore in 2019-20 to ₹73,890 crore in 2025-26**, strengthening India's position in the global seafood market.
- **Integrated Aquaparks:** PMMSY has approved **12 Integrated Aquaparks** with a total investment of **₹713.80 crore** to promote modern fisheries infrastructure and value-chain development.
- **Seaweed Cultivation:** Projects worth **₹198.17 crore** were approved during **2020-25** to promote **seaweed cultivation and allied activities**, supporting coastal livelihoods and diversification.
- **Technology-Driven Aquaculture:** PMMSY promotes high-density, resource-efficient aquaculture through technologies such as **Recirculatory Aquaculture Systems (RAS)** and Bio-floc systems. The scheme has supported 12,081 RAS and 4,205 Biofloc units, improving productivity, water-use efficiency and environmental sustainability.
- **Ornamental Fisheries:** The scheme has supported **2,672 ornamental fish rearing and integrated ornamental fish units**, encouraging diversification and entrepreneurship in the fisheries sector.
- **Fish Farmers Producer Organisations (FFPOs):** PMMSY strengthens the **collective bargaining power and economic empowerment** of fishers and fish farmers by supporting the establishment of FFPOs; between **2021-22 and 2025-26**, projects worth **₹544.86 crore** were approved for **2,195 FFPOs**.
- **Climate-Resilient Coastal Villages:** Under the **Central Sector component of PMMSY**, **100 coastal fishermen villages** have been identified as **Climate Resilient Coastal Fishermen Villages (CRCFV)**, with **₹200 lakh per village** fully funded by the Government for resilient infrastructure, livelihoods and post-harvest facilities.
- **Digital Transformation:** The **National Fisheries Digital Platform (NFDP)**, launched under **PM-MKSSY in September 2024**, provides a **single-window digital system** for formalisation,

institutional credit, aquaculture insurance, traceability, incentives, cooperatives and capacity building; as of **8 September 2026**, over **37.01 lakh individual registrations** had been recorded, with total registrations exceeding **37.23 lakh** .

Conclusion

The **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana** has emerged as a transformative initiative for India's fisheries sector by combining **production growth, infrastructure development, technology adoption and livelihood empowerment** . As India advances its **Blue Economy vision** , PMMSY will remain crucial in ensuring a **competitive, sustainable and inclusive fisheries ecosystem** while promoting responsible utilisation of aquatic resources.

Drishti Mains Practice Questions

Q. "PMMSY has emerged as a key instrument for transforming India's fisheries sector from a livelihood activity into a modern and sustainable Blue Economy sector." Discuss.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is PMMSY?

PMMSY is a scheme launched in **2020** to promote the **inclusive, sustainable and modern development of India's fisheries sector** by addressing gaps across the fisheries value chain.

2. What is the total outlay of PMMSY?

PMMSY has a total outlay of **₹20,750 crore** , with **₹2,500 crore allocated in BE 2026-27** .

3. What are the major components of PMMSY?

PMMSY has **Central Sector (CS)** and **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** components covering production, infrastructure, technology, fisher welfare, post-harvest management and fisheries governance.

4. What is PM-MKSSY?

PM-MKSSY is a **Central Sector sub-scheme under PMMSY** , operational from **2023-24 to 2026-27** , with an estimated outlay of **₹6,000 crore** , focusing on formalisation, insurance, institutional finance, quality assurance and traceability.

5. How has PMMSY improved fish production?

Fish production increased from **141.64 lakh tonnes in 2019-20 to 197.75 lakh tonnes in 2024-25** , alongside expansion of modern aquaculture and fisheries infrastructure.

[Watch Video on YouTube: ▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/o1nBU30EbXw>]

UPSC Civil Services Examination Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims :

Q. Under the Kisan Credit Card scheme, short-term credit support is given to farmers for which of the following purposes? **(2020)**

1. Working capital for maintenance of farm assets
2. Purchase of combine harvesters, tractors and mini trucks
3. Consumption requirements of farm households
4. Post-harvest expenses
5. Construction of family house and setting up of village cold storage facility

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a)** 1, 2 and 5 only
- (b)** 1, 3 and 4 only
- (c)** 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- (d)** 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Ans: (b)

Mains :

Q. Explain various types of revolutions, took place in Agriculture after Independence in India. How have these revolutions helped in poverty alleviation and food security in India? **(2017)**

Q. Defining blue revolution, explain the problems and strategies for pisciculture development in India. **(2018)**

18th BRICS Summit 2026: Adoption of the New Delhi Declaration

For Prelims: [BRICS](#) , [GIFT City](#) , [New Development Bank \(NDB\)](#) , [BRICS Grain Exchange](#) , [Ezulwini Consensus](#) , [Sirte Declaration](#) , [World Trade Organisation](#)

For Mains: India's BRICS Chairship: India's role in strengthening consensus and Global South cooperation, BRICS Expansion: Growing membership and its implications for South-South cooperation.

Source: MEA

Why in News?

India **hosted the 18 th BRICS Summit (2026)** in New Delhi, marking its **fourth BRICS Chairship** , under the theme ***"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability."*** The summit concluded with the unanimous adoption of the **New Delhi Declaration** , focusing on **multilateralism, conflict prevention and equitable global governance** .

Summary

- **The 18th BRICS Summit 2026** , hosted by India, adopted the **New Delhi Declaration** , advancing cooperation in finance, trade, technology, agriculture, health, climate and security while promoting **Global South representation and reformed multilateralism** .
- India's Chairship focused on converting BRICS' expanding representation into **tangible outcomes** through initiatives such as local-currency payments, digital public infrastructure, resilient supply chains, food security and stronger counter-terrorism cooperation.

What are the Key Outcomes of the 18 th BRICS Summit (2026)?

Financial, Economic & Trade Initiatives

- **Cross-Border Payments & Local Currency:** Mandated the **BRICS Payment Task Force** to advance the interoperability of payment and messaging channels for trade settlements using [local currencies](#), aiming to insulate BRICS economies from Western financial sanctions and exchange rate volatility.
- **BRICS Risk Lab & Insurance Resilience:** Endorsed India's proposal to host a **BRICS Risk Lab at [GIFT City, Gujarat](#)**, to build a self-reliant reinsurance ecosystem that mitigates geopolitical risks for large-scale Global South infrastructure projects.
- **MSME Invoice Discounting (Jaipur Consensus):** BRICS countries welcomed the **Jaipur Consensus** to study the establishment of an **Invoice Discounting Mechanism** to help MSMEs unlock working capital from unpaid invoices and strengthen their participation in international trade.
- **Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA):** Approved amendments to the [CRA Treaty](#) and initiated the 9th Test Run to strengthen the bloc's internal financial safety net, ensuring swift liquidity support during balance-of-payment crises without relying on the [International Monetary Fund \(IMF\)](#).
- **Taxation & Customs Cooperation:** Launched the **BRICS Tax Cross-Learning Lab and the Authorised Economic Operator (AEO) Action Plan 2026**, mandating annual joint customs enforcement operations to dismantle smuggling networks, prevent illicit financial flows, and streamline legitimate trade.

- BRICS gave **in-principle approval** to an agreement on customs cooperation to facilitate legitimate trade, strengthen border security, and combat illicit trade.
- **New Development Bank (NDB) & Multilateral Guarantees:** Launched the **BRICS- NDB Knowledge Portal** and advanced pilot transactions for Multilateral Guarantees to de-risk infrastructure projects and effectively mobilize private institutional capital for developing nations.
- **Innovation & Financing:** Proposed the **BRICS Startup Innovation Fund** to finance early-stage ventures.

Science, Technology, and Digital Infrastructure

- **Space & Satellite Cooperation:** Expanded the **BRICS Remote Sensing Satellite Constellation** and drafted terms for the **BRICS Space Council to democratize access to outer space technology** and utilize collective satellite data for disaster risk reduction and climate monitoring.
- **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI):** Approved the creation of a **BRICS DPI Repository** and initiated pilot projects to share scalable, open-source digital public goods (like digital identity and payment systems), preventing monopolistic control by private tech giants.
- **Global Research Advanced Infrastructure Network (GRAIN):** Adopted an Action Plan to pool financial and intellectual resources for high-cost megascience projects, ensuring long-term technological sovereignty for member states.
- **Submarine Cable Network:** Tasked a feasibility study for a direct high-speed submarine communication network to ensure secure, resilient data connectivity that bypasses traditional routing choke points controlled by Western entities.
- **Energy Grids & Startup Ecosystem:** Established the **Digital Centre of Excellence for Smart Grids** to integrate renewable energy seamlessly using AI, and launched the **BRICS Incubator Network** to catalyze innovation-led economic growth and foster entrepreneurship.

Agriculture and Food Security

- **BRICS Grain Exchange:** BRICS aims to **launch the Grain Exchange by 2027** . Proposed in **2023** and championed by **Russia** , it seeks to strengthen food security, reduce grain price volatility, and facilitate intra-BRICS trade.
- **BRICS AGRIN (Agro-Inputs, Genetic Resources, and Information Network):** It is a collaborative, voluntary, and farmer-centric cooperation framework established by BRICS nations to strengthen joint efforts in seeds, germplasm, and agricultural inputs.
 - India showcased its culinary diplomacy by serving Gucchi Marmik, featuring rare **Himalayan Gucchi mushrooms**. Delegates were also given **Koraput coffee from Odisha**, promoting Vocal for Local and grassroots economic empowerment.
- **Global Forum on Farmers' Rights in Seed Systems:** A platform dedicated to protecting farmers' rights, preserving **traditional agricultural knowledge** , and **addressing shared seed system challenges**.
- **Centres of Excellence on Agroecology & Regenerative Agriculture:** A network established to promote natural and sustainable farming practices for climate resilience and productivity.
- **BRICS Network on Digital Agriculture:** A tech-focused initiative to scale modern digital solutions across agriculture, agroforestry, fisheries, and aquaculture.

Health and Medicine

- **BRICS Mission for Healthy Lifestyle:** The declaration endorses a **BRICS Mission for Healthy**

Lifestyle along with a Joint Roadmap for Healthy Lifestyle Promotion (2026-2029).

- **Mental Health & Traditional Medicine:** Created a Training Hub Network led by India's **NIMHANS** for mental well-being and established an Expert Working Group to integrate safe traditional medicine into modern health systems, advancing affordable Universal Health Coverage.
- **BRICS BioDesign Initiative:** Spearheaded by the **Andhra Pradesh MedTech Zone (AMTZ)**, the newly launched **BRICS BioDesign Centre** will advance cross-border healthcare innovation.
 - It aims to combine scientific expertise to translate medical ideas into accessible and deployable healthcare solutions for the Global South.

Transport, Logistics, and Climate

- **BRICS Logistics Supply-Chain Cooperation Framework:** BRICS **agreed on a voluntary framework** to strengthen the resilience and sustainability of transport logistics and supply chains through technical cooperation, knowledge sharing, and capacity building.
- **BRICS Cooperation on Global Value Chains:** BRICS adopted the **GVC Action Plan 2026-2030**, including a **Technical Council and Joint Study**, to make global value chains more resilient and efficient while promoting **market opening and economic diversification**.
- **Sustainable Aviation & Urban Mobility:** BRICS **launched a Sustainable Aviation Fuels Forum**, created the **BRICS Urban Mobility Hub**, and adopted **Voluntary Principles for Climate-Resilient Urban Infrastructure** to promote sustainable and resilient transport systems.
- **Climate Adaptation & Forestry:** Adopted principles for Integrated **Landscape-Based Greening and Wildfire Preparedness** to combat desertification, protect vital carbon sinks like tropical forests, and enhance community-level resilience against extreme weather.

Security, Law, and Society

- **Counter-Terrorism:** Condemned cross-border terrorism and the **2025 Pahalgam terror attack**, urging the adoption of the **UN Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism** to hold perpetrators accountable and dismantle terror financing networks.
- **Asset Recovery & Corruption:** Established an **Expert Network and a Repository for Tracing Fugitive Offenders** to deny safe havens to economic offenders, trace illicit financial flows, and facilitate the legal recovery of stolen national assets.
- **Labour, Social Security & Culture:** BRICS **welcomed the adoption of BRICS CONNECT (BRICS Cooperation Network for Capacity Building, Employability, and New Skills and Technologies)** to strengthen the rights of gig workers and promote **cross-border portability of social security**, along with an **Artist Registry** to protect cultural heritage and curb illicit trafficking of antiquities.
- **BRICS Youth Cooperation:** The declaration **adopted the BRICS Youth Cooperation Framework 2026** and the **Joint Statement of the 2026 BRICS Youth Ministers' Meeting**, while establishing a **Working Group on Sport Technology**.

Geopolitical Mandates and Endorsements

- **UNSC Reform:** BRICS officially backed the **Ezulwini Consensus** and **Sirte Declaration** to secure African representation in a reformed **UN Security Council**, alongside explicit support from China and Russia for the aspirations of India and Brazil, aiming to rectify the Global South's historical underrepresentation in global security decisions.
- **WTO & ICAO Expansion:** Formally endorsed the **World Trade Organisation (WTO) accession bids of Ethiopia and Iran**, and backed Ethiopia and Indonesia for newly expanded seats on the

International Civil Aviation Organization Council to amplify developing nations' voices in global standard-setting.

- **Future Chairship:** Confirmed **China as the host for the 19th BRICS Summit in 2027** to ensure the seamless continuation and implementation of the New Delhi Declaration's vast institutional mandates.
- **Roadmap for Global Governance Reform:** India proposed a 10-point roadmap to reform global governance based on the **"3Rs" (Representation, Responsiveness, and Rule-making)** . This aims to transform the current international system from a "pyramid of privilege" to a "platform of partnership".

New Delhi blueprint



BRICS

ARCHIS MOHAN

With 140 paragraphs, the New Delhi Declaration was one of the longest joint statements issued across the 18 Brics summits since 2009. In his concluding address on Sunday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said India's chairship focused on four pillars: resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability. Here are some of the key outcomes:

Resilience

- Integrated Early Warning System for infectious diseases
- Digital centre of excellence for smart grids, energy storage
- Continue work on Brics submarine

Innovation

- Develop plan for Solar cooperation
- Network linking traditional agro-ecology knowledge with modern science
- Establish centres of excellence for mental health

Cooperation

- Brics 'Connect' to promote skills, capacity building and employability
- Brics Payment Task Force to continue work on cross-border payments
- India to host Brics Risk Lab at GIFT City
- New Investment Platform in works
- Repository to

Global governance

- Reiterate call for reforms in financial institutions
- NDB to expand local-currency financing, diversify funding sources
- NDB Knowledge Portal launched
- Oppose CBAMs
- Criticise 'indiscriminate rising of tariffs and non-tariff measures'
- Condemn the April 22, 2025, Pahalgam terror attack
- Acknowledge China's expansion of zero-tariff for 53 African countries

- support tracing of fugitive, including economic, offenders

India's BRICS Chairships: Evolution from Continuity to Consensus

2012: Laying the Institutional Foundation

- **Theme:** *"BRICS Partnership for Global Stability, Security and Prosperity."*
- **New Development Bank (NDB):** Proposed the creation of a multilateral institution to mobilize resources for infrastructure and sustainable development projects in emerging economies.
- **Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA):** Laid the conceptual foundation for a financial safety mechanism designed to provide short-term liquidity support against global financial instability.
- **Intra-Bloc Trade:** Championed the **Master Agreement on Extending Credit Facility in Local Currency** to mitigate currency risks and boost internal trade.

2016: Expanding Regional Outreach (Goa Summit)

- **Theme:** *"Building Responsive, Inclusive and Collective Solutions."*
- **NDB Rollout:** Formally operationalized the NDB, disbursing its first tranches of loans primarily for renewable energy projects.
- **Regional Integration:** Hosted the joint **BRICS-BIMSTEC Outreach Summit** to bridge commercial, technological, and security ties across the Bay of Bengal.
- **Security & FATF:** Mandated alignment with **Financial Action Task Force (FATF)** standards to curb cross-border terror financing.
- **Research Platforms:** Agreed to establish the BRICS Agriculture Research Platform, Railway Research Network, and Sports Council.

2021 (Virtual) — Consolidation & Technological Resilience

- **Theme:** *BRICS@15: Intra-BRICS Cooperation for Continuity, Consolidation and Consensus*
- **Counter-Terrorism:** Adopted the unified BRICS Counter-Terrorism Action Plan to operationalize intelligence and enforcement coordination.
- **Health & Pandemic Preparedness:** Launched the **BRICS Vaccine R&D Centre** and convened the inaugural **BRICS Digital Health Summit**.
- **Space Data Sharing:** Signed the BRICS Remote Sensing Satellite Constellation Agreement to exchange satellite data for climate and disaster management.
- **Resource Governance:** Instituted the **BRICS Alliance for Green Tourism** and organized the first ministerial meeting on sustainable water management.

Click here to Read: [BRICS and India's Strategic Opportunity](#)

BRICS Evolution and Expansion of the Global South

- **Origin to Formal Bloc:** The acronym 'BRIC' was originally coined by **Goldman Sachs in 2001** . It formalized as a political grouping in 2006, held its **first summit in Yekaterinburg (2009)** , and became **BRICS when South Africa joined in 2010** .
- **Expanded Membership & Economic Weight:** The bloc now comprises **11 full members** (Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, and the UAE). Together, they represent a massive **49.5% of the global population, 40% of global GDP, and 26% of global trade** .
- **New "Partner Country" Framework:** To accommodate growing global interest without altering the core structure, **10 countries** (including Belarus, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, and Vietnam) were inducted as Partner Countries in 2025, broadening opportunities for **South-South cooperation** .
- **Reforming Global Governance:** Beyond economic coordination, BRICS acts as a collective voice demanding greater equity and representation in the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)**, **World Bank**, and the **WTO** , pushing back against protectionism.
- **Presidency Rotation:** Historically, the Presidency **rotates annually on January 1st** based on the acronym. Due to the recent rapid expansion, a **new rotation formula** is currently being deliberated among member states.



Conclusion

India's 2026 BRICS Chairship seeks to translate the grouping's growing representation into **meaningful cooperation and tangible outcomes** . By strengthening consensus and advancing cooperation on development, technology, climate, energy and finance, BRICS can emerge as a **constructive force for a more inclusive and resilient global order** .

Drishti Mains Question:

Q. Examine the significance of India's 2026 BRICS Chairship in advancing reformed multilateralism and greater representation of the Global South.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the New Delhi Declaration?

The **New Delhi Declaration** was unanimously adopted at the 18th BRICS Summit 2026, focusing on **multilateralism, conflict prevention and equitable global governance** .

2. What is the BRICS Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA)?

The **CRA is a financial safety net** providing liquidity support during balance-of-payments crises. The 2026 summit approved amendments and initiated its **9th Test Run** .

3. What is BRICS AGRIN?

BRICS AGRIN (Agro-Inputs, Genetic Resources and Information Network) is a voluntary, farmer-centric framework for cooperation in **seeds, germplasm and agricultural inputs** .

4. What is the BRICS GVC Action Plan 2026-2030?

It aims to make **global value chains more resilient and efficient** through a Technical Council and Joint Study, while promoting **market opening and economic diversification** .

5. What is the significance of BRICS expansion?

With **11 full members** , BRICS has expanded its demographic and economic weight, strengthening its potential as a platform for **South-South cooperation and Global South representation** .

[Watch Video on YouTube:

▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/S8h57yxJKsk>]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Questions (PYQs)

Prelims

Q. With reference to "Gucchi" sometimes mentioned in the news, consider the following statements: (2022)

1. It is a fungus.
2. It grows in some Himalayan Forest areas.
3. It is commercially cultivated in the Himalayan foothills of north-eastern India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

1. 1 only
2. 3 only
3. 1 and 2
4. 2 and 3

Ans: C

Q. With reference to a grouping of countries known as BRICS, consider the following statements: (2014)

1. The First Summit of BRICS was held in Rio de Janeiro in 2009.
2. South Africa was the last to join the BRICS grouping.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans: (b)

Q. Consider the following statements: (2016)

1. New Development Bank has been set up by APEC.
2. The headquarters of the New Development Bank is in Shanghai.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans: (b)

Q. The 'Fortaleza Declaration', recently in the news, is related to the affairs of (2015)

- (a) ASEAN
- (b) BRICS
- (c) OECD
- (d) WTO

Ans: (b)

Mains

Q. India has recently signed to become a founding member of New Development Bank (NDB) and also the Asian Infrastructure Bank (AIIB). How will the role of the two Banks be different? Discuss the strategic significance of these two Banks for India. **(2014)**

NCPCR Probes Meta Over CSEAM Ads on Social Media

Source: TH

Why in News?

The **National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR)** summoned senior executives of **Meta** (parent company of Facebook, Instagram, and WhatsApp) regarding the promotion of advertisements linked to **Child Sexual Exploitative and Abuse Material (CSEAM)** on its platforms.

- Concurrently, the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** issued a stern notice, demanding Meta to disable all such content and explain the severe gaps in its algorithmic safeguards.

Why are CSEAM Ads Appearing on Social Media Platforms?

- **Limitations of AI Filters:** Automated safety systems mostly look for direct keywords or previously banned images.
 - They struggle to catch manipulated text, secret codewords, or disguised visuals used by criminals to bypass security checks.
- **Systemic Misclassification:** Moderation tools often mistakenly label child abuse material as general "adult content." This bypasses strict child-safety rules and hides the true scale of the problem.
- **Lack of Oversight in Ad Networks:** Platforms rely heavily on third-party global ad agencies. These agencies often operate with relaxed checks, allowing illegal ads to slip through in the pursuit of ad revenue.
- **External Links (Bait Strategy):** The advertisements usually do not show illegal images directly. Instead, they act as "bait," providing links or QR codes that direct users to secret, encrypted chat groups (like Telegram) where the actual material is sold.
- **Human Moderation Errors:** Overburdened or inadequately trained human reviewers often make mistakes, frequently dismissing user complaints and wrongly declaring illegal ads as safe.

Legal & Regulatory Framework Against CSEAM in India

- **POCSO Act, 2012:** Strict criminal liability for the creation, storage, distribution, or facilitation of **Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM)**.
 - **Section 19** makes it legally binding for any person or commercial entity possessing knowledge of sexual offenses against children to immediately report it to the Special Juvenile Police Unit or the local police.
- **Information Technology Act, 2000:**
 - **Section 67B:** Specifically prescribes punishment (up to 5 years imprisonment on first conviction) for publishing, transmitting, or facilitating material depicting children in sexually explicit acts in electronic form.
 - **Section 79 (Safe Harbour):** Provides intermediaries legal immunity for third-party content hosted on their platforms, **contingent** upon observing strict "due diligence".
- **IT (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021:** Social media intermediaries must deploy automated tools to proactively identify and disable content related to child sexual exploitation.
 - Platforms must appoint a resident Chief Compliance Officer, a Nodal Contact Person, and a Grievance Officer based in India.
 - Failure to remove CSEAM upon receipt of court order or government notice results in the forfeiture of safe-harbor protections under Section 79.
- **Government Mechanisms to Combat Online CSAM:** The **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal** enables citizens to report cybercrimes involving children, while the **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** coordinates investigation and enforcement efforts.
 - Internationally, the NCRB shares cyber-tipline reports received through its cooperation with the NCMEC, US, with States and Union Territories for further action..
- **UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC), 1989:** A legally binding international agreement setting out civil, political, economic, and cultural rights of children. India ratified the UNCRC in **1992** .

What is the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR)?

- **Statutory Status:** Established in March 2007 under the **Commissions for Protection of Child Rights (CPCR) Act, 2005** .
- **Nodal Ministry:** Functions under the administrative control of the **Ministry of Women and Child Development (MoWCD)** .
- **Composition:** Consists of a **Chairperson** and **six members** (at least two must be women) appointed by the Central Government.
- **Key Mandates:** Ensures that all laws, policies, and administrative mechanisms align with **child rights as enshrined in the Constitution of India and the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC)** .
 - Monitors the implementation of the **Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012** and the **Right to Education (RTE) Act, 2009** .
- **Quasi-Judicial Powers:** While conducting inquiries, NCPCR exercises specified powers of a civil court under the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 (now **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023**):

- Can summon and enforce the attendance of witnesses under oath.
- Can require the discovery and production of documents or digital evidence.
- Can requisition public records or reports from any court or office.
- **Limitation:** It has recommendatory powers; it cannot directly punish an offender or pass executable decrees, but can recommend prosecution or relief to governments/courts.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the role of NCPCR in protecting children?

NCPCR is a statutory body under the **CPCR Act, 2005** , mandated to monitor child-rights safeguards and implementation of laws such as **POCSO and RTE** .

2. What does Section 67B of the Information Technology Act, 2000 deal with?

Section 67B penalises publishing, transmitting or facilitating **sexually explicit material involving children** in electronic form.

3. What is the significance of Section 79 of the Information Technology Act, 2000?

Section 79 provides **safe-harbour protection to intermediaries** , subject to compliance with prescribed **due-diligence requirements** .

5. What is the UNCRC?

The **UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989)** is a legally binding framework protecting children's civil, political, economic and social rights; **India ratified it in 1992**

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[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/Ts9oi2v_sfl](https://www.youtube.com/embed/Ts9oi2v_sfl)]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims

Q.1 In India, under cyber insurance for individuals, which of the following benefits are generally covered, in addition to payment for the loss of funds and other benefits? (2020)

1. Cost of restoration of the computer system in case of malware disrupting access to one's computer
2. Cost of a new computer if some miscreant wilfully damages it, if proved so
3. Cost of hiring a specialised consultant to minimise the loss in case of cyber extortion
4. Cost of defence in the Court of Law if any third party files a suit

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 only
- (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans: (b)

Q.2 In India, it is legally mandatory for which of the following to report on cyber security incidents? (2017)

1. Service providers
2. Data centres
3. Body corporate

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (d)

Mains

Q. What are the different elements of cyber security ? Keeping in view the challenges in cyber security, examine the extent to which India has successfully developed a comprehensive National Cyber Security Strategy. **(2022)**

Amendments to Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2026 Source: DD

Source: DD

The **Department of Consumer Affairs** has notified the **Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) (Amendment) Rules, 2026** to bolster consumer rights, mandate fair trade practices, and curb deceptive digital tactics, aiming to balance consumer protection with the ease of doing business.

- **Statutory Framework & Timeline:** Notified under the broader framework of the **Consumer Protection Act, 2019**, these amendment rules will officially come into force on **1 st January 2027**.
- **Integration with NCH:** **E-commerce** entities must mandatorily partner with the **National Consumer Helpline (NCH)** convergence process to strengthen the national grievance redressal mechanism.
- **Search & Pricing Transparency:** The rules prohibit **search result manipulation**, mandate clear identification of **sponsored listings**, and require displaying the lowest prior price (from the preceding 30 days) during promotional sales.
- **Regulating Dark Patterns:** The rules mandate strict compliance with the **Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023**, requiring platforms to conduct a **yearly self-audit** and display a compliance certificate.
- **Consumer Data & Consent:** Platforms are prohibited from using consumer information for specified purposes without the user's express and affirmative consent.
- **Product Disclosures:** Marketplaces must disclose vital information, including 'best-before' dates, return/refund policies, importer details, and the country of origin for imported goods.
- **Anti-Bundling Rules:** Imposing bundled fees for services unrelated to the platform is banned, with exceptions for loyalty or membership programs.

Consumer Protection Act, 2019

- The **Consumer Protection Act, 2019** replaced the **Consumer Protection Act, 1986** to strengthen consumer rights in the digital age, covering **e-commerce, direct selling and misleading advertisements**.
- It established the **Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA)**, equipping it with *suo-motu* powers to investigate unfair trade practices, order product recalls, penalize misleading ads, and enforce statutory accountability on e-commerce platforms.
- It also significantly strengthened the three-tier **consumer dispute redressal mechanism (District, State, and National Commissions)** through rationalized pecuniary jurisdictions and procedural innovations.
 - These include the **e-Daakhil portal for nationwide online grievance filing**, zero filing fees for cases up to Rs 5 lakh, and the deemed admissibility of complaints within 21 days.

Read more: Consumer Protection Act, 2019

International Criminal Court (ICC)

Source: TH

Why in News?

The **International Criminal Court (ICC)** is facing renewed pressure after the **United States launched measures against the Court**, including sanctions on ICC officials and efforts to encourage member states to withdraw, while Venezuela and Chad announced plans to leave the Rome Statute.

- The developments have renewed concerns over the **legitimacy, universality and effectiveness of the international criminal justice system** .

Why is the International Criminal Court (ICC) Facing Growing Withdrawal Pressure?

- **U.S. Opposition:** The U.S. has intensified pressure against the ICC, citing concerns over national sovereignty and the Court's investigations involving **U.S. personnel in Afghanistan** and Israeli officials over the Gaza conflict.
- **African Concerns: Mali, Burkina Faso and Niger** have accused the ICC of **selective justice and neo-colonialism** , alleging that the Court disproportionately focuses on African situations.
 - **Burundi became the first country** to withdraw from the ICC in 2017, criticising what it viewed as unequal attention towards African conflicts.
- **Accountability vs Sovereignty:** The withdrawals highlight the tension between **international criminal accountability** and principles of **state sovereignty and non-interference** .
- **Withdrawal Is Not Retrospective:** A country's withdrawal does **not terminate the ICC's jurisdiction over crimes committed while it was a member** , as illustrated by the Philippines, where an ICC investigation continued after its withdrawal.

What are the Key Facts About the International Criminal Court (ICC)?

- **About:** The ICC is the **world's first permanent international criminal court** , established under the **Rome Statute** , adopted on **17th July 1998** and which entered into force on **1st July 2002** . It is headquartered in **The Hague, Netherlands** .
 - The ICC was **created to end impunity for the most serious international crimes** and ensure accountability when national justice systems fail.
 - **The ICC is independent of the United Nations** , although the **UN Security Council can refer situations** to it.
- **Core Crimes:** The ICC has jurisdiction over four crimes— **genocide, crimes against humanity, war crimes and the crime of aggression** .
- **Jurisdiction:** The ICC **prosecutes individuals, not states** , for crimes committed after **1st July 2002**.

It follows the principle of complementarity, meaning it acts as a court of last resort and intervenes only when national authorities are unwilling or unable to genuinely carry out investigations or prosecutions.

- **Territorial Jurisdiction:** It generally exercises jurisdiction over crimes committed in **States Parties** , or over nationals of States Parties; it can also exercise jurisdiction in **non-member states through a UNSC referral** .
- **Membership:** The **Rome Statute has 125 States Parties** . **India, the US, China and Israel** are not parties to the ICC. India has raised concerns relating to **sovereignty and the UNSC 's referral powers** .
- **Structure:** The ICC has four principal organs—the **Presidency, Judicial Divisions, Office of the Prosecutor and Registry** . The **Assembly of States Parties (ASP)** provides legislative oversight and governance.
- **Enforcement:** The ICC has **no independent police or enforcement force** and therefore depends on **State cooperation** for arrest and surrender of accused persons, asset freezing and enforcement of sentences.
- **Key Limitation:** The effectiveness of the ICC depends heavily on **international cooperation** , making arrest and enforcement difficult when states refuse to cooperate or when major powers remain outside the Rome Statute.

Differences between the ICJ and the ICC

The International Court of Justice (ICJ) and the International Criminal Court (ICC) are two courts with different functions within the international legal system.

	 ICJ International Court of Justice	 ICC International Criminal Court
Established	1945	2002
UN-relationship	Highest court of the UN	Not part of the UN
Location	The Hague, the Netherlands	The Hague, the Netherlands
Jurisdiction	UN member-states	Individuals
Types of cases	Legal disputes between states and requests for advisory opinions on legal questions	Prosecutes individuals for the most serious crimes as per the Rome Statute
Appeals	No	Yes
Enforcement power	None - relies on the UN Security Council to uphold judgements, with permanent members having veto power	None - relies on cooperation from member states to enforce its decisions

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q. What is the International Criminal Court (ICC)?

The **ICC** is the world's first permanent international criminal court, established under the **Rome Statute** to prosecute individuals responsible for the most serious international crimes.

Q. Which crimes fall under the ICC's jurisdiction?

The ICC has jurisdiction over **genocide, crimes against humanity, war crimes and the crime of aggression**.

Q. Does the ICC prosecute countries or individuals?

The ICC prosecutes **individuals**, not States, for internationally recognised core crimes.

Q. What is the principle of complementarity?

Complementarity means the ICC intervenes only when national courts are **unwilling or genuinely unable** to investigate or prosecute serious international crimes.

Q. Can the ICC prosecute nationals of a non-member country?

Yes, jurisdiction can arise when the alleged crime occurs on the territory of a **State Party**, the accused is a national of a State Party, or the **UN Security Council refers** a situation to the ICC.

[Watch Video on YouTube:

▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/D_mv5-Du6i0

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UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Questions (PYQs)

Prelims

Q. "Rule of Law Index" is released by which of the following? (2018)

- a) Amnesty International
- b) International Court of Justice
- c) The Office of the UN Commissioner for Human Rights
- d) World Justice Project

Answer: (d)